News

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CONSUMER PRICE INDEX: SEPTEMBER 2004

The Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) increased 0.2 percent in September, before seasonal adjustment, the Bureau of Labor Statistics of the U.S. Department of Labor reported today. The September level of 189.9 (1982-84=100) was 2.5 percent higher than in September 2003.

The Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W) also increased 0.2 percent in September, prior to seasonal adjustment. The September level of 185.4 was 2.4 percent higher than in September 2003.

The Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U) increased 0.3 percent in September on a not seasonally adjusted basis. The September level of 110.6 (December 1999=100) was 2.1 percent higher than in September 2003. Please note that the indexes for the post-2002 period are subject to revision.

CPI for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U)

On a seasonally adjusted basis, the CPI-U increased 0.2 percent in September, following a 0.1 percent increase in August. Energy costs declined for the third consecutive month--down 0.4 percent in September--after advancing sharply in the first half of the year. Within energy, the index for household fuels decreased 0.9 percent, while the index for motor fuel rose 0.1 percent. The index for food was unchanged in September, as a 0.2 percent decline in the index for food at home was offset by a 0.3 percent increase in the index for food away from home. The index for all items less food and energy advanced 0.3 percent in September, following increases of 0.1 percent in each of the preceding three months. While each of the non-food major groups, including the non-energy portions of housing and transportation, contributed to the larger advance in September, the sharp upturn in the lodging away from home component accounted for about three-fourths of the acceleration in the index for all items excluding food and energy.

Table A. Percent changes in CPI for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U)

Expenditure Category	Seasonally adjusted								Un-adjusted 12-mos. ended Sep. '04
	Changes from preceding month							Compound annual rate 3-mos. ended Sep. '04	
	2004								
	Mar.	Apr.	May	June	July	Aug.	Sep.		
All Items	.5	.2	.6	.3	-.1	.1	.2	.6	2.5
Food and beverages	.2	.2	.9	.2	.2	.1	.0	1.3	3.3
Housing	.3	.4	.4	.3	.2	.2	.2	2.3	2.8
Apparel	.9	.0	.3	.2	-.8	-.2	.0	-4.2	-.7
Transportation	1.1	.1	1.7	.8	-.8	-.3	.2	-3.8	2.2
Medical care	.6	.4	.3	.3	.3	.2	.3	3.5	4.4
Recreation	.3	.2	-.2	.3	-.2	-.2	.2	-.7	.8
Education and communication	.1	.3	.0	.2	-.1	.1	.4	1.8	1.8
Other goods and services	.2	.1	.1	.1	.3	.2	.3	3.2	2.1
Special Indexes									
Energy	1.9	.1	4.6	2.6	-1.9	-.3	-.4	-9.8	6.7
Food	.2	.2	.9	.2	.3	.1	.0	1.3	3.3
All Items less food and energy	.4	.3	.2	.1	.1	.1	.3	1.8	2.0

Consumer prices increased at a seasonally adjusted annual rate (SAAR) of 0.6 percent in the third quarter of 2004, following increases in the first and second quarters at annual rates of 5.1 and 4.8 percent, respectively. This brings the year-to-date annual rate to 3.5 percent and compares with an increase of 1.9 percent in all of 2003. The index for energy, which advanced at annual rates of 38.6 and 33.5 percent in the first two quarters, declined at a 9.8 percent rate in the third quarter of 2004. Thus far this year, energy costs have risen at an 18.6 percent SAAR after increasing 6.9 percent in all of 2003. In the first nine months of 2003, petroleum-based energy costs increased at a 31.7 percent rate and charges for energy services increased at a 6.2 percent rate. The food index rose at a 2.6 percent SAAR in the first nine months of 2004. The index for grocery store food prices increased at a 1.9 percent rate. Among the six major grocery store food groups, the index for dairy products registered the largest increase during this span--up at a 7.3 percent rate--although it declined in each month during the third quarter. The index for fruits and vegetables recorded the largest decline--down at a 0.8 percent annual rate.

The CPI-U excluding food and energy advanced at a 1.8 percent SAAR in the third quarter, following increases at rates of 2.9 and 2.3 percent in the first two quarters of 2004. The advance at a 2.3 percent SAAR for the first nine months of 2004 compares with a 1.1 percent rise in all of 2003. With the exception of the recreation component, each of the major groups--including alcoholic beverages and the non-energy portion of the housing and transportation groups--advanced at a faster rate in the first 9 months of 2004 than in all of 2003. Most of the overall acceleration, however, was accounted for by a larger increase in the indexes for shelter, an upturn in the index for new and used vehicles, and a smaller decline in the index for apparel. The annual rates for selected groups for the last seven and three-quarter years are shown below.

	Percentage change 12 months ended in December							**SAAR 9 mos. ended in Sep.**
	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004
All items	1.7	1.6	2.7	3.4	1.6	2.4	1.9	3.5
Food and beverages	1.6	2.3	2.0	2.8	2.8	1.5	3.5	2.5
Housing	2.4	2.3	2.2	4.3	2.9	2.4	2.2	3.3
Apparel	1.0	-.7	-.5	-1.8	-3.2	-1.8	-2.1	-.1
Transportation	-1.4	-1.7	5.4	4.1	-3.8	3.8	.3	7.0
Medical care	2.8	3.4	3.7	4.2	4.7	5.0	3.7	4.4
Recreation	1.5	1.2	.8	1.7	1.5	1.1	1.1	.9
Education and communication	3.0	.7	1.6	1.3	3.2	2.2	1.6	1.8
Other goods and services	5.2	8.8	5.1	4.2	4.5	3.3	1.5	2.4
Special indexes								
Energy	-3.4	-8.8	13.4	14.2	-13.0	10.7	6.9	18.6
Energy commodities	-6.9	-15.1	29.5	15.7	-24.5	23.7	6.9	31.7
Energy services	.2	-3.3	1.2	12.7	-1.5	.4	6.9	6.2
All items less energy	2.1	2.4	2.0	2.6	2.8	1.8	1.5	2.4
Food	1.5	2.3	1.9	2.8	2.8	1.5	3.6	2.6
All items less food and energy	2.2	2.4	1.9	2.6	2.7	1.9	1.1	2.3

The food and beverages index was unchanged in September. The index for food at home decreased 0.2 percent, the same as in August. The index for dairy products declined for the third consecutive month, down 2.0 percent in September. Milk prices also declined for the third consecutive month--down 3.4 percent in September--but were 8.7 percent higher than in September 2003. Also contributing to the decrease in the food at home index were declines in the indexes for other food at home and for meats, poultry, fish, and eggs--down 0.5 and 0.3 percent, respectively. Within the latter index, declines in prices for eggs, for beef, and for poultry more than offset price increases for pork and for fish and seafood. The index for fruits and vegetables increased 0.7 percent. The indexes for fresh fruits and for fresh vegetables rose 0.6 and 1.5 percent, respectively, while the index for processed fruits and vegetables fell 0.5 percent. The two other major grocery store food groups-- nonalcoholic beverages and cereals and bakery products--rose 0.3 and 0.1 percent, respectively. The other two components of the food and beverage index--food away from home and alcoholic beverages--increased 0.3 and 0.5 percent, respectively.

The index for housing rose 0.2 percent in September, the same as in each of the preceding two months. Shelter costs, which increased 0.1 percent in August, advanced 0.4 percent in September. The index for lodging away from home increased 2.9 percent in September, following a 1.7 percent decrease in August. The indexes for rent and owners' equivalent rent each increased 0.1 percent after advancing 0.3 percent in August. The index for fuels and utilities fell 0.5 percent in September. The index for fuel oil rose 2.1 percent in September and was 29.0 percent higher than a year earlier. The index for electricity was unchanged, while the index for natural gas decreased 3.1 percent. During the last 12 months, these indexes have advanced 1.6 and 6.2 percent, respectively. The index for household furnishings and operations was unchanged in September, following declines in the preceding two months.

The transportation index rose 0.2 percent in September, following declines in each of the preceding two months. The index for gasoline, which declined in July and August, increased 0.1 percent in September. (Prior to seasonal adjustment, gasoline prices fell 0.4 percent in September.) The index for used cars and trucks advanced for the third consecutive month--up 2.0 percent in September. Despite the recent advances, used car and truck prices are 1.8 percent lower than a year ago. Partially offsetting these increases, the index for new vehicles declined 0.2 percent in September. (About 17 percent of the new car sample in September was represented by 2005 models.) New vehicle prices are 1.1 percent lower than in September 2003. The index for public transportation decreased 1.1 percent, reflecting a 1.6 percent decline in airline fares.

The index for apparel, which declined in each of the preceding two months, was unchanged in September. (Prior to seasonal adjustment, apparel prices rose 4.0 percent, reflecting the introduction of fall-winter wear. The proportion of fall-winter clothing introduced in this September was about the same as in recent years.)

Medical care costs rose 0.3 percent in September to a level 4.4 percent higher than a year ago. The index for medical care commodities--prescription drugs, nonprescription drugs, and medical supplies--increased 0.4 percent. The index for medical care services rose 0.3 percent in September. Charges for professional services and for hospital and related services increased 0.1 and 0.6 percent, respectively.

The index for recreation turned up in September, advancing 0.2 percent after registering declines of the same magnitude in July and August. Increases in the indexes for cable and satellite television and radio services and for admissions to movies, theaters, concerts, and sporting events--up 0.6 and 0.8 percent, respectively--were largely responsible for the September increase.

The index for education and communication increased 0.4 percent in September. Educational costs rose 0.6 percent, reflecting increases in the indexes for college tuition and for elementary and high school tuition--up 0.8 and 0.9 percent, respectively. (Prior to seasonal adjustment, charges for college tuition and fees rose 2.9 percent in September and were 8.9 percent higher than a year ago.) The index for communication costs increased 0.3 percent. The index for telephone services rose 0.3 percent, reflecting a 1.9 percent increase in long distance charges. The index for personal computers and peripheral equipment declined 0.7 percent.

The index for other goods and services rose 0.3 percent in September. The index for tobacco and smoking products increased 0.3 percent. The index for personal care increased 0.2 percent. Within personal care, the index for miscellaneous personal services--legal services, funeral expenses, laundry and dry cleaning and other apparel services, and financial services--rose 0.3 percent in September.

CPI for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W)

On a seasonally adjusted basis, the CPI for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers increased 0.2 percent in September.

Table B. Percent changes in CPI for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W)

Expenditure Category	Seasonally adjusted								Un-adjusted 12-mos. ended Sep. '04
	Changes from preceding month							Compound annual rate 3-mos. ended Sep. '04	
	2004								
	Mar.	Apr.	May	June	July	Aug.	Sep.		
All Items	.5	.2	.7	.3	-.1	.1	.2	.7	2.4
Food and beverages	.2	.2	.9	.2	.3	.1	.0	1.3	3.4
Housing	.2	.3	.3	.4	.3	.2	.1	2.4	2.7
Apparel	.8	-.1	.2	.0	-.7	-.4	.3	-3.3	-.3
Transportation	1.3	-.1	2.1	.7	-.9	-.2	.4	-2.9	2.2
Medical care	.6	.4	.3	.3	.3	.2	.4	3.8	4.5
Recreation	.3	.0	.0	.2	-.3	-.2	.2	-1.1	.7
Education and communication	.1	.2	-.2	.2	-.1	.0	.4	1.1	1.0
Other goods and services	.2	.2	.1	.1	.4	.2	.3	3.6	2.1
Special Indexes									
Energy	2.2	-.1	5.0	2.7	-2.0	-.5	-.3	-10.5	6.9
Food	.2	.1	1.0	.1	.3	.1	-.1	1.3	3.3
All Items less food and energy	.3	.2	.1	.2	.1	.1	.3	1.9	1.8

Consumer Price Index data for October are scheduled for release on Wednesday, November 17, 2004, at 8:30 A.M. (EST).

Facilities for Sensory Impaired

Information from this release will be made available to sensory impaired individuals upon request. Voice phone: 202-691-5200, Federal Relay Services: 1-800-877-8339. For a recorded message of Summary CPI data, call (202) 691-5200.

Brief Explanation of the CPI

The Consumer Price Index (CPI) is a measure of the average change in prices over time of goods and services purchased by households. The Bureau of Labor Statistics publishes CPIs for two population groups: (1) the CPI for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W), which covers households of wage earners and clerical workers that comprise approximately 32 percent of the total population and (2) the CPI for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) and the Chained CPI for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U), which cover approximately 87 percent of the total population and include in addition to wage earners and clerical worker households, groups such as professional, managerial, and technical workers, the self-employed, short-term workers, the unemployed, and retirees and others not in the labor force.

The CPIs are based on prices of food, clothing, shelter, and fuels, transportation fares, charges for doctors' and dentists' services, drugs, and other goods and services that people buy for day-to-day living. Prices are collected in 87 urban areas across the country from about 50,000 housing units and approximately 23,000 retail establishments-department stores, supermarkets, hospitals, filling stations, and other types of stores and service establishments. All taxes directly associated with the purchase and use of items are included in the index. Prices of fuels and a few other items are obtained every month in all 87 locations. Prices of most other commodities and services are collected every month in the three largest geographic areas and every other month in other areas. Prices of most goods and services are obtained by personal visits or telephone calls of the Bureau's trained representatives.

In calculating the index, price changes for the various items in each location are averaged together with weights, which represent their importance in the spending of the appropriate population group. Local data are then combined to obtain a U.S. city average. For the CPI-U and CPI-W separate indexes are also published by size of city, by region of the country, for cross-classifications of regions and population-size classes, and for 27 local areas. Area indexes do not measure differences in the level of prices among cities; they only measure the average change in prices for each area since the base period. For the C-CPI-U data are issued only at the national level. It is important to note that the CPI-U and CPI-W are considered final when released, but the C-CPI-U is issued in preliminary form and subject to two annual revisions.

The index measures price change from a designed reference date. For the CPI-U and the CPI-W the reference base is 1982-84 equals 100.0. The reference base for the C-CPI-U is December 1999 equals 100.
An increase of 16.5 percent from the reference base, for example, is shown as 116.5. This change can also be expressed in dollars as follows: the price of a base period market basket of goods and services in the CPI has risen from $10 in 1982-84 to $11.65.

For further details visit the CPI home page on the Internet at http://www.bls.gov/cpi/ or contact our CPI Information and Analysis Section on (202) 691-7000.

Calculating Index Changes

Movements of the indexes from one month to another are usually expressed as percent changes rather than changes in index points, because index point changes are affected by the level of the index in relation to its base period while percent changes are not. The example below illustrates the computation of index point and percent changes.

Percent changes for 3-month and 6-month periods are expressed as annual rates and are computed according to the standard formula for compound growth rates. These data indicate what the percent change would be if the current rate were maintained for a 12-month period.

Index Point Change

CPI	115.7
Less previous index	111.2
Equals index point change	4.5

Percent Change

Index point difference	4.5
Divided by the previous index	111.2
Equals	0.040
Results multiplied by one hundred	0.040x100
Equals percent change	4.0

Regions Defined

The states in the four regions shown in Tables 3 and 6 are listed below.

The Northeast--Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Vermont.
The Midwest--Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Michigan, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, Ohio, South Dakota, and Wisconsin.
The South--Alabama, Arkansas, Delaware, Florida, Georgia, Kentucky, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, North Carolina, Oklahoma, South Carolina, Tennessee, Texas, Virginia, West Virginia, and the District of Columbia.
The West--Alaska, Arizona, California, Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Oregon, Utah, Washington, and Wyoming.

A Note on Seasonally Adjusted and Unadjusted Data

Because price data are used for different purposes by different groups, the Bureau of Labor Statistics publishes seasonally adjusted as well as unadjusted changes each month.

For analyzing general price trends in the economy, seasonally adjusted changes are usually preferred since they eliminate the effect of changes that normally occur at the same time and in about the same magnitude every year--such as price movements resulting from changing climatic conditions, production cycles, model changeovers, holidays, and sales.

The unadjusted data are of primary interest to consumers concerned about the prices they actually pay. Unadjusted data also are used extensively for escalation purposes. Many collective bargaining contract agreements and pension plans, for example, tie compensation changes to the Consumer Price Index unadjusted for seasonal variation.

Seasonal factors used in computing the seasonally adjusted indexes are derived by the X-12-ARIMA Seasonal Adjustment Method. The updated seasonal data at the end of 1977 replaced data from 1967 through 1977. Subsequent annual updates have replaced 5 years of seasonal data, e.g., data from 1999 through 2003 were replaced at the end of 2003. In January 2002, dependently seasonally adjusted series were revised for January 1987-December 2001 as a result of a change in the aggregation weights for dependently adjusted series. For further information, please see "Aggregation of Dependently Adjusted Seasonally Adjusted Series," in the October 2001 issue of the CPI Detailed Report.

The seasonal movement of All items and 54 other aggregations is derived by combining the seasonal movement of 73 selected components. Each year the seasonal status of every series is reevaluated based upon certain statistical criteria. If any of the 73 components change their seasonal adjustment status from seasonally adjusted to not seasonally adjusted, not seasonally adjusted data will be used for the last 5 years, but the seasonally adjusted indexes will be used before that period. Note: 47 of the 73 components are seasonally adjusted for 2004.

Seasonally adjusted data, including the All items index levels, are subject to revision for up to five years after their original release. For this reason, BLS advises against the use of these data in escalation agreements.

Effective with the calculation of the seasonal factors for 1990, the Bureau of Labor Statistics has used an enhanced seasonal adjustment procedure called Intervention Analysis Seasonal Adjustment for some CPI series. Intervention Analysis Seasonal Adjustment allows for better estimates of seasonally adjusted data. Extreme values and/or sharp movements which might distort the seasonal pattern are estimated and removed from the data prior to calculation of seasonal factors. Beginning with the calculation of seasonal factors for 1996, X-12-ARIMA software was used for Intervention Analysis Seasonal Adjustment.

For the fuel oil, natural gas, motor fuels, and educational books and supplies indexes, this procedure was used to offset the effects that extreme price volatility would otherwise have had on the estimates of seasonally adjusted data for those series. For the Nonalcoholic beverages index, the procedure was used to offset the effects of labor and supply problems for coffee. The procedure was used to account for unusual butter fat supply reductions, decreases in milk supply, and large swings in soybean oil inventories affecting the Fats and oils series. For the Water and sewerage maintenance index, the procedure was used to account for a data collection anomaly and dry weather in California. For Dairy products, it mitigated the effects of significant changes in milk production levels and higher demand for cheese.

For Electricity, it was used to offset an increase in demand due to warmer than expected weather, increased rates to conserve supplies, and declining natural gas inventories. For New vehicles, New cars, and New trucks, the procedure was used to offset the effects of a model changeover combined with financing incentives.

For additional information on seasonal adjustment in the CPI, please write to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, Division of Consumer Prices and Price Indexes, Washington, DC 20212 or contact Daniel Chow on (202) 691-6968 by e-mail at Chow.Daniel@bls.gov. If you have general questions about the CPI, please call our information staff at (202) 691-7000.

Table 1. Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U): U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-U

Expenditure category	Relative importance, December 2003	Unadjusted indexes		Unadjusted percent change to Sep. 2004 from—		Seasonally adjusted percent change from—		
		Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	Aug. 2004	June to July	July to Aug.	Aug. to Sep.
All items	100.000	189.5	189.9	2.5	0.2	-0.1	0.1	0.2
All items (1967=100)	-	567.6	568.7	-	-	-	-	-
Food and beverages	15.384	187.3	187.2	3.3	-.1	.2	.1	.0
Food	14.383	186.8	186.7	3.3	-.1	.3	.1	.0
Food at home	8.256	186.7	186.1	3.3	-.3	.2	-.2	-.2
Cereals and bakery products	1.202	207.2	206.4	1.4	-.4	.1	.0	.1
Meats, poultry, fish, and eggs	2.320	183.7	183.4	7.2	-.2	.8	.0	-.3
Dairy and related products	.842	184.9	181.6	6.6	-1.8	-.6	-1.8	-2.0
Fruits and vegetables	1.221	224.0	226.0	.7	.9	-.2	.2	.7
Nonalcoholic beverages and beverage materials	.905	140.3	140.3	.8	.0	.3	.0	.3
Other food at home	1.765	166.2	165.2	1.3	-.6	.2	.1	-.5
Sugar and sweets	.305	164.4	163.5	.7	-.5	.4	.6	-.4
Fats and oils	.251	169.7	170.4	8.1	.4	-.2	-1.3	.4
Other foods	1.210	180.9	179.4	.0	-.8	.3	.2	-.7
Other miscellaneous foods [1] [2]	.308	111.5	110.5	-.5	-.9	-1.4	1.9	-.9
Food away from home [1]	6.127	188.4	188.9	3.3	.3	.4	.3	.3
Other food away from home [2]	.332	125.4	125.9	3.4	.4	-.1	.2	.1
Alcoholic beverages [1]	1.001	192.5	193.4	2.9	.5	-.1	.2	.5
Housing	42.089	191.2	191.0	2.8	-.1	.2	.2	.2
Shelter	32.878	220.3	220.2	3.0	.0	.2	.1	.4
Rent of primary residence [3]	6.157	211.9	212.4	2.8	.2	.2	.3	.1
Lodging away from home [2]	2.954	130.6	127.2	7.3	-2.6	1.1	-1.7	2.9
Owners' equivalent rent of primary residence [3] [4]	23.383	225.7	226.1	2.4	.2	.1	.3	.1
Tenants' and household insurance [1] [2]	.385	116.3	116.6	.6	.3	-.1	.2	.3
Fuels and utilities	4.741	167.7	166.7	4.4	-.6	.4	.8	-.5
Fuels	3.830	150.5	149.3	4.1	-.8	.4	.9	-.9
Fuel oil and other fuels	.231	157.4	161.6	23.8	2.7	3.0	5.3	1.9
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	3.599	157.6	156.0	3.0	-1.0	.2	.6	-1.0
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	.910	125.3	125.7	6.3	.3	.6	.4	.4
Household furnishings and operations	4.470	124.8	125.0	-.2	.2	-.3	-.2	.0
Household operations [1] [2]	.704	126.1	126.1	3.1	.0	.6	.5	.0
Apparel	3.975	116.5	121.2	-.7	4.0	-.8	-.2	.0
Men's and boys' apparel	1.024	113.8	116.2	-.9	2.1	.0	-1.3	-.3
Women's and girls' apparel	1.704	107.5	114.4	-1.0	6.4	-1.1	-.3	-.6
Infants' and toddlers' apparel	.195	115.0	119.5	-3.7	3.9	.4	-1.4	1.9
Footwear	.778	117.3	121.7	1.2	3.8	-1.8	1.6	2.0
Transportation	16.881	162.9	162.9	2.2	.0	-.8	-.3	.2
Private transportation	15.817	159.1	159.4	2.6	.2	-.9	-.3	.3
New and used motor vehicles [2]	7.912	93.4	93.9	-1.3	.5	.0	.1	.5
New vehicles	4.817	134.9	134.9	-1.1	.0	-.7	-.3	-.2
Used cars and trucks [1]	2.007	133.8	136.5	-1.8	2.0	1.1	1.3	2.0
Motor fuel	3.249	162.0	161.2	9.6	-.5	-4.0	-1.5	.1
Gasoline (all types)	3.222	161.2	160.5	9.6	-.4	-4.2	-1.4	.1
Motor vehicle parts and equipment [1]	.369	109.0	109.3	1.5	.3	.6	.2	.3
Motor vehicle maintenance and repair	1.349	200.8	200.7	2.3	.0	.4	.2	-.2
Public transportation	1.064	209.7	205.3	-2.8	-2.1	.4	-1.4	-1.1
Medical care	6.074	311.6	312.3	4.4	.2	.3	.2	.3
Medical care commodities	1.499	270.0	270.9	2.3	.3	.0	.1	.4
Medical care services	4.575	323.1	323.7	5.0	.2	.4	.2	.3
Professional services	2.749	273.3	273.3	4.2	.0	.3	.5	.1
Hospital and related services [3]	1.489	418.8	420.3	5.2	.4	.6	-.4	.6

See footnotes at end of table.

Table 1. Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U): U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group-Continued

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-U

	Relative importance, December 2003	Unadjusted indexes		Unadjusted percent change to Sep. 2004 from—		Seasonally adjusted percent change from—		
		Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	Aug. 2004	June to July	July to Aug.	Aug. to Sep.
Expenditure category								
Recreation [2]	5.872	108.5	108.6	0.8	0.1	-0.2	-0.2	0.2
Video and audio [2]	1.736	104.1	104.0	.5	-.1	.1	-.3	.3
Education and communication [2]	5.948	111.7	112.9	1.8	1.1	-.1	.1	.4
Education [2]	2.841	145.1	147.9	6.6	1.9	.4	.6	.6
Educational books and supplies	.219	353.3	352.8	4.3	-.1	-.1	1.0	-.9
Tuition, other school fees, and childcare	2.623	418.3	427.4	6.9	2.2	.4	.7	.6
Communication [2]	3.107	86.1	86.2	-2.7	.1	-.6	-.5	.3
Information and information processing [1 2]	2.925	84.0	84.1	-3.0	.1	-.2	-.6	.1
Telephone services [1 2]	2.315	95.0	95.3	-2.2	.3	-.2	-.6	.3
Information technology, hardware and services [1 5]	.610	14.7	14.7	-5.8	.0	-.7	-.7	.0
Personal computers and peripheral equipment [1 2]	.230	15.1	15.0	-8.0	-.7	-1.3	-1.3	-.7
Other goods and services	3.776	305.5	306.3	2.1	.3	.3	.2	.3
Tobacco and smoking products [1]	.806	481.6	482.9	3.0	.3	.9	.2	.3
Personal care	2.970	181.9	182.3	1.8	.2	.1	.2	.2
Personal care products [1]	.680	152.8	153.5	.1	.5	-.3	-.4	.5
Personal care services [1]	.650	198.9	199.1	1.9	.1	.3	.7	.1
Miscellaneous personal services	1.448	295.2	295.9	3.7	.2	.3	.3	.3
Commodity and service group								
Commodities	40.117	154.2	154.9	1.9	.5	-.5	-.1	.1
Food and beverages	15.384	187.3	187.2	3.3	-.1	.2	.1	.0
Commodities less food and beverages	24.733	135.6	136.7	1.0	.8	-.9	-.3	.1
Nondurables less food and beverages	13.458	156.1	157.8	3.1	1.1	-.3	-.6	-1.1
Apparel	3.975	116.5	121.2	-.7	4.0	-.8	-.2	.0
Nondurables less food, beverages, and apparel	9.483	184.4	184.4	4.5	.0	-1.9	-.4	.1
Durables	11.275	113.7	114.1	-1.4	.4	-.3	.0	.4
Services	59.883	224.5	224.5	2.9	.0	.3	.1	.3
Rent of shelter [4]	32.494	229.4	229.3	3.0	.0	.3	.0	.3
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	.385	116.3	116.6	.6	.3	-.1	.2	.3
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	3.599	157.6	156.0	3.0	-1.0	.2	.6	-1.0
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	.910	125.3	125.7	6.3	.3	.6	.4	.4
Household operations [1 2]	.704	126.1	126.1	3.1	.0	.6	.5	.0
Transportation services	6.319	220.8	220.1	1.5	-.3	.5	-.1	.0
Medical care services	4.575	323.1	323.7	5.0	.2	.4	.2	.3
Other services	10.896	261.9	263.8	2.6	.7	.1	.2	.5
Special indexes								
All items less food	85.617	189.9	190.4	2.4	.3	-.1	.0	.2
All items less shelter	67.122	179.5	180.1	2.3	.3	-.2	.0	.1
All items less medical care	93.926	183.2	183.6	2.5	.2	-.1	.0	.2
Commodities less food	25.734	137.7	138.8	1.1	.8	-.9	-.3	.2
Nondurables less food	14.459	158.2	159.9	3.0	1.1	-.4	-.4	-1.0
Nondurables less food and apparel	10.484	184.3	184.4	4.4	.1	-1.7	-.6	.2
Nondurables	28.842	171.9	172.8	3.2	.5	-.2	-.3	-.6
Services less rent of shelter [4]	27.389	235.6	235.9	2.9	.1	.1	.4	.1
Services less medical care services	55.308	216.2	216.1	2.8	.0	.2	.2	.2
Energy	7.080	155.3	154.3	6.7	-.6	-1.9	-.3	-.4
All items less energy	92.920	194.7	195.2	2.2	.3	.1	.1	.3
All items less food and energy	78.537	196.8	197.4	2.0	.3	.1	.1	.3
Commodities less food and energy commodities	22.254	138.1	139.4	-.6	.9	-.3	-.1	.2
Energy commodities	3.480	162.5	162.0	10.3	-.3	-3.7	-1.0	.2
Services less energy services	56.283	231.4	231.6	3.0	.1	.3	.1	.3
Purchasing power of the consumer dollar (1982-84=$1.00)	-	$ .528	$ .527	-	-	-	-	-
Purchasing power of the consumer dollar (1967=$1.00)	-	$ .176	$ .176	-	-	-	-	-

[1] Not seasonally adjusted.
[2] Indexes on a December 1997=100 base.
[3] This index series was calculated using a Laspeyres estimator. All other item stratum index series were calculated using a geometric means estimator.
[4] Indexes on a December 1982=100 base.
[5] Indexes on a December 1988=100 base.
- Data not available.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 2. Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U): Seasonally adjusted U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-U

Expenditure category	Seasonally adjusted indexes				Seasonally adjusted annual rate percent change for					
					3 months ended—				6 months ended—	
	June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Dec. 2003	Mar. 2004	June 2004	Sep. 2004	Mar. 2004	Sep. 2004
All items	189.4	189.3	189.4	189.7	-0.4	5.1	4.8	0.6	2.3	2.7
Food and beverages	186.9	187.3	187.5	187.5	5.6	1.5	4.9	1.3	3.6	3.1
Food	186.4	186.9	187.0	187.0	5.9	1.3	5.1	1.3	3.6	3.2
Food at home	186.9	187.3	187.0	186.6	7.7	-.2	6.7	-.6	3.7	3.0
Cereals and bakery products	206.0	206.2	206.3	206.6	.8	2.2	1.6	1.2	1.5	1.4
Meats, poultry, fish, and eggs	182.5	183.9	183.9	183.4	23.6	-3.7	8.5	2.0	9.1	5.2
Dairy and related products	189.9	188.7	185.3	181.6	4.5	.0	47.9	-16.4	2.2	11.2
Fruits and vegetables	227.5	227.0	227.4	228.9	5.2	-2.2	-2.6	2.5	1.4	-.1
Nonalcoholic beverages and beverage materials	139.9	140.3	140.3	140.7	1.2	.6	-.9	2.3	.9	.7
Other food at home	165.5	165.8	165.9	165.1	.5	4.2	1.5	-1.0	2.3	.2
Sugar and sweets	162.7	163.3	164.2	163.5	.7	.7	-.2	2.0	.7	.9
Fats and oils	172.0	171.7	169.4	170.0	3.9	20.3	14.4	-4.6	11.8	4.5
Other foods	179.7	180.2	180.6	179.4	-.2	2.0	-1.1	-.7	.9	-.9
Other miscellaneous foods [1 2]	110.9	109.4	111.5	110.5	-4.3	7.1	-2.8	-1.4	1.3	-2.1
Food away from home [1]	187.0	187.8	188.4	188.9	3.3	3.3	2.6	4.1	3.3	3.4
Other food away from home [2]	125.2	125.1	125.4	125.5	4.4	5.0	3.3	1.0	4.7	2.1
Alcoholic beverages [1]	192.4	192.2	192.5	193.4	1.7	4.5	3.4	2.1	3.1	2.7
Housing	189.6	190.0	190.3	190.7	1.3	3.5	4.1	2.3	2.4	3.2
Shelter	218.8	219.3	219.5	220.4	2.5	3.4	3.2	3.0	2.9	3.1
Rent of primary residence [3]	210.9	211.4	212.1	212.4	2.1	2.3	3.7	2.9	2.2	3.3
Lodging away from home [2]	125.6	127.0	124.9	128.5	7.9	8.1	3.9	9.6	8.0	6.7
Owners' equivalent rent of primary residence [3 4]	225.0	225.3	225.9	226.1	2.0	2.5	3.1	2.0	2.3	2.5
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	116.2	116.1	116.3	116.6	-5.4	2.8	3.9	1.4	-1.4	2.6
Fuels and utilities	162.7	163.3	164.6	163.7	-3.8	5.5	15.0	2.5	.8	8.6
Fuels	145.3	145.9	147.2	145.9	-5.9	5.6	16.7	1.7	-.3	8.9
Fuel oil and other fuels	153.3	157.9	166.2	169.3	-1.2	25.6	27.7	48.8	11.4	37.8
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	152.1	152.4	153.3	151.7	-6.1	4.2	16.2	-1.0	-1.1	7.2
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	123.9	124.6	125.1	125.6	5.5	6.8	6.7	5.6	6.2	6.2
Household furnishings and operations	125.5	125.1	124.9	124.9	-.6	1.9	.0	-1.9	.6	-1.0
Household operations [1 2]	124.7	125.5	126.1	126.1	1.0	3.3	3.6	4.6	2.1	4.1
Apparel	121.4	120.4	120.1	120.1	-2.3	2.0	2.0	-4.2	-.2	-1.2
Men's and boys' apparel	118.6	118.6	117.1	116.8	1.0	.3	1.4	-5.9	.7	-2.4
Women's and girls' apparel	114.2	113.0	112.7	112.0	-1.4	2.5	3.6	-7.5	.5	-2.1
Infants' and toddlers' apparel	117.7	118.2	116.6	118.8	-12.6	3.4	-8.4	3.8	-5.0	-2.5
Footwear	119.0	116.9	118.8	121.2	-2.6	1.7	-1.7	7.6	-.5	2.9
Transportation	165.0	163.6	163.1	163.4	-11.0	14.9	10.9	-3.8	1.1	3.3
Private transportation	161.3	159.8	159.4	159.9	-12.0	16.3	11.7	-3.4	1.2	3.9
New and used motor vehicles [2]	93.8	93.8	93.9	94.4	-6.1	-.4	-.4	2.6	-3.3	1.1
New vehicles	137.6	136.7	136.3	136.0	-1.4	.9	.9	-4.6	-.3	-1.9
Used cars and trucks [1]	130.6	132.1	133.8	136.5	-21.1	.6	-1.8	19.3	-10.9	8.2
Motor fuel	169.9	163.1	160.7	160.9	-37.0	87.1	51.7	-19.6	8.6	10.4
Gasoline (all types)	169.3	162.2	160.0	160.1	-36.9	86.6	52.3	-20.0	8.5	10.4
Motor vehicle parts and equipment [1]	108.2	108.8	109.0	109.3	.0	.4	1.5	4.1	.2	2.8
Motor vehicle maintenance and repair	199.9	200.7	201.2	200.7	3.3	.8	3.3	1.6	2.0	2.4
Public transportation	208.8	209.6	206.6	204.3	-.9	1.7	-3.4	-8.3	.4	-5.9
Medical care	309.9	310.9	311.6	312.6	4.2	5.8	3.8	3.5	5.0	3.7
Medical care commodities	269.4	269.3	269.7	270.9	.8	2.9	3.2	2.2	1.8	2.7
Medical care services	321.0	322.3	323.1	324.0	5.3	6.8	4.1	3.8	6.1	3.9
Professional services	271.3	272.0	273.3	273.6	3.5	7.0	2.9	3.4	5.2	3.1
Hospital and related services [3]	418.1	420.4	418.8	421.2	6.9	5.5	5.5	3.0	6.2	4.3

See footnotes at end of table.

Table 2. Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U): Seasonally adjusted U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group-Continued

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-U

	Seasonally adjusted indexes				Seasonally adjusted annual rate percent change for					
					3 months ended—				6 months ended—	
	June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Dec. 2003	Mar. 2004	June 2004	Sep. 2004	Mar. 2004	Sep. 2004
Expenditure category										
Recreation [2]	108.9	108.7	108.5	108.7	0.7	2.2	1.1	-0.7	1.5	0.2
Video and audio [2]	104.3	104.4	104.1	104.4	.0	.4	1.2	.4	.2	.8
Education and communication [2]	111.6	111.5	111.6	112.1	1.5	1.8	1.8	1.8	1.6	1.8
Education [2]	143.3	143.9	144.8	145.6	6.6	6.5	6.7	6.6	6.5	6.6
Educational books and supplies	351.3	350.9	354.3	351.1	11.4	2.0	4.4	-.2	6.6	2.1
Tuition, other school fees, and childcare	413.0	414.8	417.5	420.2	6.2	7.0	6.8	7.2	6.6	7.0
Communication [2]	87.0	86.5	86.1	86.4	-3.6	-2.7	-2.3	-2.7	-3.1	-2.5
Information and information processing [1 2]	84.7	84.5	84.0	84.1	-2.3	-2.3	-4.6	-2.8	-2.3	-3.7
Telephone services [1 2]	95.8	95.6	95.0	95.3	-.8	-2.0	-3.7	-2.1	-1.4	-2.9
Information technology, hardware and services [1 5]	14.9	14.8	14.7	14.7	-7.5	-2.6	-7.7	-5.3	-5.1	-6.5
Personal computers and peripheral equipment [1 2]	15.5	15.3	15.1	15.0	-2.4	-9.5	-7.4	-12.3	-6.0	-9.9
Other goods and services	303.9	304.8	305.5	306.3	1.2	2.8	1.3	3.2	2.0	2.3
Tobacco and smoking products [1]	476.0	480.5	481.6	482.9	1.5	2.7	2.0	5.9	2.1	4.0
Personal care	181.3	181.5	181.9	182.3	1.1	2.7	1.3	2.2	1.9	1.8
Personal care products [1]	153.8	153.4	152.8	153.5	.0	2.9	-1.8	-.8	1.4	-1.3
Personal care services [1]	196.9	197.5	198.9	199.1	-2.2	3.1	2.3	4.5	.4	3.4
Miscellaneous personal services	293.6	294.4	295.2	296.2	3.8	4.1	3.5	3.6	4.0	3.5
Commodity and service group										
Commodities	155.8	155.0	154.8	155.0	-3.6	7.4	6.4	-2.0	1.7	2.1
Food and beverages	186.9	187.3	187.5	187.5	5.6	1.5	4.9	1.3	3.6	3.1
Commodities less food and beverages	138.1	136.9	136.5	136.7	-9.1	11.0	7.3	-4.0	.4	1.5
Nondurables less food and beverages	158.4	158.0	157.0	155.2	-.3	13.7	8.2	-7.8	6.5	-.1
Apparel	121.4	120.4	120.1	120.1	-2.3	2.0	2.0	-4.2	-.2	-1.2
Nondurables less food, beverages, and apparel	188.4	184.9	184.1	184.3	-15.0	28.9	19.0	-8.4	4.7	4.4
Durables	114.5	114.2	114.2	114.6	-4.4	.7	-1.7	.3	-1.9	-.7
Services	222.8	223.4	223.7	224.3	2.0	3.5	3.7	2.7	2.8	3.2
Rent of shelter [4]	228.1	228.7	228.8	229.5	2.4	3.6	3.6	2.5	3.0	3.0
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	116.2	116.1	116.3	116.6	-5.4	2.8	3.9	1.4	-1.4	2.6
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	152.1	152.4	153.3	151.7	-6.1	4.2	16.2	-1.0	-1.1	7.2
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	123.9	124.6	125.1	125.6	5.5	6.8	6.7	5.6	6.2	6.2
Household operations [1 2]	124.7	125.5	126.1	126.1	1.0	3.3	3.6	4.6	2.1	4.1
Transportation services	220.1	221.1	220.8	220.8	1.3	2.0	1.5	1.3	1.7	1.4
Medical care services	321.0	322.3	323.1	324.0	5.3	6.8	4.1	3.8	6.1	3.9
Other services	261.0	261.3	261.8	263.0	2.0	2.8	2.5	3.1	2.4	2.8
Special indexes										
All items less food	189.9	189.8	189.8	190.2	-1.3	5.5	4.8	.6	2.1	2.7
All items less shelter	180.0	179.7	179.7	179.9	-1.6	5.8	5.5	-.2	2.1	2.6
All items less medical care	183.2	183.1	183.1	183.4	-.4	4.8	5.0	.4	2.1	2.7
Commodities less food	140.1	138.9	138.5	138.8	-8.5	10.8	6.8	-3.7	.7	1.5
Nondurables less food	160.5	159.9	159.2	157.6	-.3	12.9	7.8	-7.0	6.1	.1
Nondurables less food and apparel	188.2	185.0	183.9	184.2	-13.1	26.8	17.9	-8.2	4.9	4.0
Nondurables	173.3	172.9	172.4	171.4	3.2	6.9	7.5	-4.3	5.0	1.4
Services less rent of shelter [4]	233.5	233.8	234.7	235.0	2.1	2.5	4.6	2.6	2.3	3.6
Services less medical care services	214.5	214.9	215.3	215.7	2.1	2.7	3.8	2.3	2.4	3.0
Energy	156.4	153.4	153.0	152.4	-22.2	38.6	33.5	-9.8	3.8	9.7
All items less energy	194.5	194.7	194.8	195.3	1.7	2.7	2.7	1.7	2.2	2.2
All items less food and energy	196.6	196.8	196.9	197.5	.8	2.9	2.3	1.8	1.9	2.1
Commodities less food and energy commodities	139.7	139.3	139.1	139.4	-2.8	1.4	.3	-.9	-.7	-.3
Energy commodities	169.7	163.5	161.8	162.2	-35.2	82.5	50.2	-16.5	8.8	11.9
Services less energy services	230.0	230.6	230.9	231.7	2.5	3.4	3.0	3.0	3.0	3.0

[1] Not seasonally adjusted.
[2] Indexes on a December 1997=100 base.
[3] This index series was calculated using a Laspeyres estimator. All other item stratum index series were calculated using a geometric means estimator.
[4] Indexes on a December 1982=100 base.
[5] Indexes on a December 1988=100 base.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 3. Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U): Selected areas, all items index

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

All items

CPI-U	Pricing schedule [1]	Indexes				Percent change to Sep.2004 from—			Percent change to Aug.2004 from—		
		June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Aug. 2003	June 2004	July 2004
U.S. city average	M	189.7	189.4	189.5	189.9	2.5	0.3	0.2	2.7	-0.1	0.1
Region and area size [2]											
Northeast urban	M	201.1	201.0	201.0	201.2	3.2	.1	.1	3.4	.0	.0
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	203.3	203.0	203.1	203.2	3.0	.1	.0	3.3	-.1	.0
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	118.7	119.2	118.9	119.2	3.7	.0	.3	3.9	.2	-.3
Midwest urban	M	183.3	183.2	183.3	183.6	2.3	.2	.2	2.5	.0	.1
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	185.3	185.4	185.6	185.9	2.1	.3	.2	2.4	.2	.1
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	116.8	116.3	116.5	116.8	2.5	.4	.3	2.6	-.3	.2
Size D - Nonmetropolitan (less than 50,000)	M	176.9	177.1	176.3	176.4	2.4	-.4	.1	2.4	-.3	-.5
South urban	M	182.9	182.6	182.6	182.8	2.5	.1	.1	2.6	-.2	.0
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	184.3	183.7	183.7	184.0	2.2	.2	.2	2.2	-.3	.0
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	117.0	116.9	116.9	116.9	2.7	.0	.0	3.1	-.1	.0
Size D - Nonmetropolitan (less than 50,000)	M	180.5	180.1	180.0	181.2	2.8	.6	.7	2.3	-.3	-.1
West urban	M	193.3	192.9	193.0	193.8	2.2	.5	.4	2.0	-.2	.1
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	195.9	195.4	195.5	196.4	2.1	.5	.5	2.0	-.2	.1
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	117.9	117.9	118.1	118.4	2.4	.4	.3	2.3	.2	.2
Size classes											
A [4]	M	173.4	173.1	173.2	173.6	2.4	.3	.2	2.5	-.1	.1
B/C [3]	M	117.3	117.3	117.3	117.4	2.7	.1	.1	3.0	.0	.0
D	M	181.8	181.3	181.0	181.8	2.5	.3	.4	2.2	-.4	-.2
Selected local areas [5]											
Chicago-Gary-Kenosha, IL-IN-WI	M	189.1	189.2	190.2	190.0	2.1	.4	-.1	3.1	.6	.5
Los Angeles-Riverside-Orange County, CA	M	193.7	193.4	193.1	194.5	3.3	.6	.7	3.3	-.3	-.2
New York-Northern N.J.-Long Island, NY-NJ-CT-PA	M	206.0	205.5	205.7	205.9	3.2	.2	.1	3.3	-.1	.1
Boston-Brockton-Nashua, MA-NH-ME-CT	1	-	208.9	-	209.8	1.5	.4	-	-	-	-
Cleveland-Akron, OH	1	-	181.7	-	183.8	3.0	1.2	-	-	-	-
Dallas-Fort Worth, TX	1	-	179.1	-	179.7	1.5	.3	-	-	-	-
Washington-Baltimore, DC-MD-VA-WV [6]	1	-	120.2	-	120.8	3.1	.5	-	-	-	-
Atlanta, GA	2	185.7	-	184.1	-	-	-	-	1.3	-.9	-
Detroit-Ann Arbor-Flint, MI	2	185.8	-	186.8	-	-	-	-	1.7	.5	-
Houston-Galveston-Brazoria, TX	2	169.3	-	169.1	-	-	-	-	3.0	-.1	-
Miami-Fort Lauderdale, FL	2	185.6	-	185.1	-	-	-	-	2.3	-.3	-
Philadelphia-Wilmington-Atlantic City, PA-NJ-DE-MD	2	198.0	-	199.1	-	-	-	-	4.2	.6	-
San Francisco-Oakland-San Jose, CA	2	199.0	-	198.7	-	-	-	-	1.2	-.2	-
Seattle-Tacoma-Bremerton, WA	2	195.3	-	194.6	-	-	-	-	.1	-.4	-

[1] Foods, fuels, and several other items priced every month in all areas; most other goods and services priced as indicated:
M - Every month.
1 - January, March, May, July, September, and November.
2 - February, April, June, August, October, and December.

[2] Regions defined as the four Census regions. See technical notes.

[3] Indexes on a December 1996=100 base.

[4] Indexes on a December 1986=100 base.

[5] In addition, the following metropolitan areas are published semiannually and appear in Tables 34 and 39 of the January and July issues of the CPI Detailed Report: Anchorage, AK; Cincinnati-Hamilton, OH-KY-IN; Denver-Boulder-Greeley, CO; Honolulu, HI; Kansas City, MO-KS; Milwaukee-Racine, WI; Minneapolis-St. Paul, MN-WI; Phoenix-Mesa, AZ; Pittsburgh, PA; Portland-Salem, OR-WA; St. Louis, MO-IL; San Diego, CA; Tampa-St. Petersburg-Clearwater, FL.

[6] Indexes on a November 1996=100 base.

- Data not available.

NOTE: Local area indexes are byproducts of the national CPI program. Each local index has a smaller sample size than the national index and is, therefore, subject to substantially more sampling and other measurement error. As a result, local area indexes show greater volatility than the national index, although their long-term trends are similar. Therefore, the Bureau of Labor Statistics strongly urges users to consider adopting the national average CPI for use in their escalator clauses.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 4. Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W): U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-W

Expenditure category	Relative importance, December 2003	Unadjusted indexes		Unadjusted percent change to Sep. 2004 from—		Seasonally adjusted percent change from—		
		Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	Aug. 2004	June to July	July to Aug.	Aug. to Sep.
All items	100.000	185.0	185.4	2.4	0.2	-0.1	0.1	0.2
All items (1967=100)	-	551.0	552.4	-	-	-	-	-
Food and beverages	17.151	186.9	186.8	3.4	-.1	.3	.1	.0
Food	16.061	186.4	186.2	3.3	-.1	.3	.1	-.1
Food at home	9.637	186.1	185.5	3.4	-.3	.1	-.1	-.3
Cereals and bakery products	1.364	207.0	206.3	1.4	-.3	.2	.0	.1
Meats, poultry, fish, and eggs	2.908	183.7	183.4	7.3	-.2	.6	.1	-.2
Dairy and related products	.955	184.9	181.4	6.6	-1.9	-.8	-1.7	-2.0
Fruits and vegetables	1.344	222.2	223.9	.2	.8	-.2	.3	.6
Nonalcoholic beverages and beverage materials	1.076	139.6	139.7	.9	.1	.2	.1	.3
Other food at home	1.991	165.8	164.8	1.2	-.6	.1	.2	-.5
Sugar and sweets	.321	163.8	163.1	.6	-.4	.4	.7	-.3
Fats and oils	.303	169.9	170.3	8.1	.2	-.1	-1.5	.1
Other foods	1.366	181.4	179.7	-.2	-.9	.2	.3	-.7
Other miscellaneous foods [1] [2]	.350	112.0	111.0	-.3	-.9	-1.5	2.1	-.9
Food away from home [1]	6.424	188.2	188.8	3.3	.3	.4	.3	.3
Other food away from home [2]	.252	125.2	125.8	3.1	.5	.0	.2	.2
Alcoholic beverages [1]	1.090	192.8	194.0	3.4	.6	-.3	.3	.6
Housing	39.114	186.6	186.5	2.7	-.1	.3	.2	.1
Shelter	30.151	213.4	213.4	2.8	.0	.3	.1	.2
Rent of primary residence [3]	8.065	211.0	211.6	2.8	.3	.2	.3	.2
Lodging away from home [2]	1.722	131.6	127.7	6.6	-3.0	1.8	-1.0	1.7
Owners' equivalent rent of primary residence [3] [4]	20.026	204.7	205.1	2.3	.2	.2	.1	.1
Tenants' and household insurance [1] [2]	.337	116.5	116.8	.9	.3	-.2	.2	.3
Fuels and utilities	5.079	167.2	166.2	4.5	-.6	.4	.8	-.6
Fuels	4.146	149.3	148.2	4.1	-.7	.3	.8	-.8
Fuel oil and other fuels	.216	156.8	161.1	24.5	2.7	3.3	5.4	2.2
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	3.930	156.8	155.3	3.1	-1.0	.1	.6	-1.0
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	.933	125.4	125.8	6.3	.3	.6	.4	.4
Household furnishings and operations	3.884	120.4	120.6	-.3	.2	-.6	-.1	.2
Household operations [1] [2]	.318	128.0	127.6	3.4	-.3	.4	.4	-.3
Apparel	4.357	115.9	120.6	-.3	4.1	-.7	-.4	.3
Men's and boys' apparel	1.120	113.3	115.6	-.8	2.0	.0	-1.4	-.1
Women's and girls' apparel	1.727	106.9	114.0	-.4	6.6	-1.0	-.5	-.4
Infants' and toddlers' apparel	.250	117.6	122.3	-3.3	4.0	.2	-1.2	2.1
Footwear	1.011	116.3	120.4	.7	3.5	-1.3	1.4	1.9
Transportation	19.145	161.4	161.6	2.2	.1	-.9	-.2	.4
Private transportation	18.348	158.6	159.1	2.4	.3	-.9	-.2	.4
New and used motor vehicles [2]	9.305	92.2	92.9	-1.6	.8	.2	.2	.8
New vehicles	4.864	136.0	136.0	-1.2	.0	-.6	-.4	-.1
Used cars and trucks [1]	3.487	134.6	137.3	-1.8	2.0	1.2	1.2	2.0
Motor fuel	3.967	162.4	161.7	9.6	-.4	-4.0	-1.6	.2
Gasoline (all types)	3.936	161.7	161.0	9.5	-.4	-4.0	-1.7	.1
Motor vehicle parts and equipment [1]	.456	108.4	108.7	1.4	.3	.4	.2	.3
Motor vehicle maintenance and repair	1.365	202.7	202.7	2.4	.0	.3	.4	-.2
Public transportation	.797	208.0	203.1	-2.5	-2.4	.6	-1.3	-1.5
Medical care	4.969	311.0	311.7	4.5	.2	.3	.2	.4
Medical care commodities	1.142	263.8	264.8	2.1	.4	.0	.2	.5
Medical care services	3.827	323.2	323.9	5.2	.2	.4	.2	.4
Professional services	2.256	275.8	275.9	4.3	.0	.3	.5	.1
Hospital and related services [3]	1.254	414.9	416.4	5.2	.4	.5	-.4	.6

See footnotes at end of table.

Table 4. Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W): U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group-Continued

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-W

	Relative importance, December 2003	Unadjusted indexes		Unadjusted percent change to Sep. 2004 from—		Seasonally adjusted percent change from—		
		Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	Aug. 2004	June to July	July to Aug.	Aug. to Sep.
Expenditure category								
Recreation [2]	5.697	106.1	106.2	0.7	0.1	-0.3	-0.2	0.2
Video and audio [2]	1.928	103.4	103.3	.6	-.1	.1	-.3	.2
Education and communication [2]	5.645	109.9	110.8	1.0	.8	-.1	.0	.4
Education [2]	2.299	143.6	146.3	6.2	1.9	.5	.6	.5
Educational books and supplies	.215	354.7	354.8	4.5	.0	-.1	1.1	-.8
Tuition, other school fees, and childcare	2.084	405.8	414.0	6.4	2.0	.5	.5	.6
Communication [2]	3.345	87.6	87.8	-2.7	.2	-.5	-.5	.3
Information and information processing [1 2]	3.194	86.2	86.3	-2.8	.1	-.2	-.6	.1
Telephone services [1 2]	2.622	95.2	95.5	-2.2	.3	-.3	-.6	.3
Information technology, hardware and services [1 5]	.572	15.3	15.2	-5.6	-.7	-.6	.0	-.7
Personal computers and peripheral equipment [1 2]	.205	14.9	14.8	-7.5	-.7	-1.3	-.7	-.7
Other goods and services	3.923	313.5	314.4	2.1	.3	.4	.2	.3
Tobacco and smoking products [1]	1.248	482.6	483.9	3.0	.3	1.0	.2	.3
Personal care	2.675	180.5	180.9	1.7	.2	.1	.2	.2
Personal care products [1]	.737	153.1	154.0	.0	.6	-.3	-.5	.6
Personal care services [1]	.610	199.5	199.7	1.8	.1	.3	.7	.1
Miscellaneous personal services	1.152	295.4	296.2	3.9	.3	.3	.3	.4
Commodity and service group								
Commodities	44.582	154.9	155.7	2.0	.5	-.4	-.1	.3
Food and beverages	17.151	186.9	186.8	3.4	-.1	.3	.1	.0
Commodities less food and beverages	27.430	137.1	138.2	1.1	.8	-.9	-.3	.4
Nondurables less food and beverages	14.671	159.5	161.2	3.4	1.1	-.4	-.6	-1.2
Apparel	4.357	115.9	120.6	-.3	4.1	-.7	-.4	.3
Nondurables less food, beverages, and apparel	10.315	190.2	190.1	4.9	-.1	-2.0	-.6	.1
Durables	12.759	113.1	113.7	-1.6	.5	-.3	.1	.7
Services	55.418	220.2	220.3	2.8	.0	.3	.2	.1
Rent of shelter [4]	29.813	205.5	205.5	2.8	.0	.2	.1	.3
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	.337	116.5	116.8	.9	.3	-.2	.2	.3
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	3.930	156.8	155.3	3.1	-1.0	.1	.6	-1.0
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	.933	125.4	125.8	6.3	.3	.6	.4	.4
Household operations [1 2]	.318	128.0	127.6	3.4	-.3	.4	.4	-.3
Transportation services	6.241	221.0	220.5	1.7	-.2	.4	.0	.0
Medical care services	3.827	323.2	323.9	5.2	.2	.4	.2	.4
Other services	10.020	254.4	256.0	2.2	.6	.1	.1	.5
Special indexes								
All items less food	83.939	184.5	185.1	2.3	.3	-.1	.0	.3
All items less shelter	69.849	176.6	177.3	2.3	.4	-.2	.0	.2
All items less medical care	95.031	179.6	180.0	2.3	.2	-.1	.0	.2
Commodities less food	28.520	139.0	140.2	1.2	.9	-.8	-.3	.4
Nondurables less food	15.761	161.5	163.2	3.4	1.1	-.2	-.6	-1.1
Nondurables less food and apparel	11.405	189.6	189.7	4.7	.1	-1.9	-.6	.1
Nondurables	31.823	173.6	174.5	3.4	.5	-.2	-.2	-.6
Services less rent of shelter [4]	25.605	209.3	209.5	2.8	.1	.2	.2	.2
Services less medical care services	51.592	212.2	212.3	2.7	.0	.2	.2	.1
Energy	8.114	155.1	154.2	6.9	-.6	-2.0	-.5	-.3
All items less energy	91.886	189.5	190.2	2.0	.4	.2	.1	.3
All items less food and energy	75.825	190.5	191.4	1.8	.5	.1	.1	.3
Commodities less food and energy commodities	24.337	138.0	139.5	-.5	1.1	-.2	.0	.4
Energy commodities	4.183	162.8	162.3	10.3	-.3	-3.6	-1.3	.3
Services less energy services	51.488	227.1	227.4	2.8	.1	.3	.1	.3
Purchasing power of the consumer dollar (1982-84=$1.00)	-	$ .541	$ .539	-	-	-	-	-
Purchasing power of the consumer dollar (1967=$1.00)	-	$ .181	$ .181	-	-	-	-	-

[1] Not seasonally adjusted.
[2] Indexes on a December 1997=100 base.
[3] This index series was calculated using a Laspeyres estimator. All other item stratum index series were calculated using a geometric means estimator.
[4] Indexes on a December 1984=100 base
[5] Indexes on a December 1988=100 base.
- Data not available.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 5. Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W): Seasonally adjusted U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-W

Expenditure category	Seasonally adjusted indexes				Seasonally adjusted annual rate percent change for					
					3 months ended—				6 months ended—	
	June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Dec. 2003	Mar. 2004	June 2004	Sep. 2004	Mar. 2004	Sep. 2004
All items	185.0	184.9	185.0	185.3	-1.1	5.4	4.9	0.7	2.1	2.8
Food and beverages	186.4	186.9	187.0	187.0	5.9	1.3	5.1	1.3	3.6	3.2
Food	185.9	186.4	186.6	186.5	6.1	1.1	5.1	1.3	3.6	3.2
Food at home	186.3	186.5	186.4	185.9	7.8	-.2	7.2	-.9	3.7	3.1
Cereals and bakery products	205.9	206.3	206.2	206.5	.0	2.6	1.6	1.2	1.3	1.4
Meats, poultry, fish, and eggs	182.7	183.8	184.0	183.6	24.1	-3.5	8.8	2.0	9.5	5.3
Dairy and related products	190.2	188.7	185.4	181.6	3.6	-.9	51.3	-16.9	1.3	12.1
Fruits and vegetables	224.9	224.4	225.1	226.4	4.0	-2.4	-3.1	2.7	.7	-.3
Nonalcoholic beverages and beverage materials	139.4	139.7	139.8	140.2	1.4	.0	.0	2.3	.7	1.2
Other food at home	165.1	165.3	165.6	164.7	.0	4.2	1.5	-1.0	2.1	.2
Sugar and sweets	161.9	162.5	163.6	163.1	-.7	1.0	-.7	3.0	.1	1.1
Fats and oils	172.3	172.2	169.7	169.9	3.3	20.0	16.1	-5.5	11.4	4.8
Other foods	180.1	180.4	181.0	179.7	-.4	1.8	-1.1	-.9	.7	-1.0
Other miscellaneous foods [1 2]	111.4	109.7	112.0	111.0	-3.5	7.1	-2.8	-1.4	1.6	-2.1
Food away from home [1]	186.8	187.6	188.2	188.8	3.3	3.1	2.6	4.4	3.2	3.5
Other food away from home [2]	125.0	125.0	125.3	125.5	4.7	3.3	3.3	1.6	4.0	2.4
Alcoholic beverages [1]	192.7	192.2	192.8	194.0	2.6	5.0	3.2	2.7	3.8	3.0
Housing	185.0	185.5	185.9	186.1	.9	3.6	4.0	2.4	2.2	3.2
Shelter	212.1	212.7	213.0	213.5	1.9	3.3	3.1	2.7	2.6	2.9
Rent of primary residence [3]	210.1	210.6	211.2	211.6	1.8	2.7	3.7	2.9	2.2	3.3
Lodging away from home [2]	125.5	127.8	126.5	128.7	5.8	9.8	1.0	10.6	7.8	5.7
Owners' equivalent rent of primary residence [3 4]	204.1	204.6	204.9	205.1	2.0	2.6	2.8	2.0	2.3	2.4
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	116.5	116.3	116.5	116.8	-4.7	2.8	4.6	1.0	-1.0	2.8
Fuels and utilities	162.1	162.7	164.0	163.0	-3.8	6.1	14.5	2.2	1.0	8.2
Fuels	144.2	144.7	145.9	144.8	-5.6	5.7	16.5	1.7	-.1	8.8
Fuel oil and other fuels	152.4	157.4	165.9	169.6	-2.9	24.8	29.0	53.4	10.1	40.7
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	151.4	151.6	152.5	151.0	-5.9	4.8	16.0	-1.1	-.7	7.1
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	124.0	124.7	125.2	125.7	5.2	7.9	6.0	5.6	6.5	5.8
Household furnishings and operations	121.2	120.5	120.4	120.6	-1.3	2.3	-.7	-2.0	.5	-1.3
Household operations [1 2]	127.0	127.5	128.0	127.6	1.3	5.3	5.2	1.9	3.3	3.5
Apparel	120.7	119.9	119.4	119.7	-1.7	3.0	.7	-3.3	.7	-1.3
Men's and boys' apparel	118.3	118.3	116.6	116.5	2.1	1.7	-.3	-5.9	1.9	-3.2
Women's and girls' apparel	113.9	112.8	112.2	111.8	-1.4	4.0	2.9	-7.2	1.2	-2.3
Infants' and toddlers' apparel	120.2	120.5	119.0	121.5	-12.4	7.4	-10.8	4.4	-3.0	-3.5
Footwear	117.6	116.1	117.7	119.9	-3.3	.3	-2.0	8.1	-1.5	2.9
Transportation	163.3	161.9	161.5	162.1	-13.2	16.0	11.5	-2.9	.4	4.1
Private transportation	160.7	159.2	158.9	159.6	-13.6	16.7	12.3	-2.7	.4	4.5
New and used motor vehicles [2]	92.2	92.4	92.6	93.3	-9.4	-.4	-.9	4.9	-5.0	2.0
New vehicles	138.6	137.8	137.3	137.1	-1.4	.6	.6	-4.3	-.4	-1.9
Used cars and trucks [1]	131.4	133.0	134.6	137.3	-21.2	.9	-1.8	19.2	-10.8	8.2
Motor fuel	170.6	163.8	161.1	161.5	-36.9	85.8	53.4	-19.7	8.3	11.0
Gasoline (all types)	170.0	163.2	160.5	160.7	-36.8	85.7	53.6	-20.2	8.3	10.8
Motor vehicle parts and equipment [1]	107.8	108.2	108.4	108.7	.4	.4	1.5	3.4	.4	2.4
Motor vehicle maintenance and repair	201.7	202.3	203.1	202.7	3.5	.8	3.2	2.0	2.1	2.6
Public transportation	206.7	207.9	205.1	202.1	-.8	3.3	-4.0	-8.6	1.3	-6.3
Medical care	309.3	310.2	310.9	312.2	4.4	6.1	3.8	3.8	5.2	3.8
Medical care commodities	263.3	263.2	263.6	264.8	.6	2.6	2.8	2.3	1.6	2.5
Medical care services	321.2	322.4	323.2	324.6	5.4	7.1	4.2	4.3	6.3	4.3
Professional services	273.8	274.5	275.8	276.2	3.7	7.4	2.7	3.6	5.5	3.1
Hospital and related services [3]	414.2	416.4	414.9	417.3	6.8	5.7	5.5	3.0	6.2	4.3

See footnotes at end of table.

Table 5. Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W): Seasonally adjusted U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group-Continued

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

CPI-W

	Seasonally adjusted indexes				Seasonally adjusted annual rate percent change for					
					3 months ended—				6 months ended—	
	June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Dec. 2003	Mar. 2004	June 2004	Sep. 2004	Mar. 2004	Sep. 2004
Expenditure category										
Recreation [2]	106.6	106.3	106.1	106.3	0.8	2.3	0.8	-1.1	1.5	-0.2
Video and audio [2]	103.6	103.7	103.4	103.6	.4	.4	1.6	.0	.4	.8
Education and communication [2]	110.0	109.9	109.9	110.3	.7	1.5	.7	1.1	1.1	.9
Education [2]	142.0	142.7	143.5	144.2	5.7	6.8	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.9
Educational books and supplies	352.2	351.8	355.8	353.1	10.7	2.1	4.3	1.0	6.3	2.7
Tuition, other school fees, and childcare	401.1	403.3	405.4	407.9	5.4	7.1	5.9	7.0	6.2	6.4
Communication [2]	88.5	88.1	87.7	88.0	-3.5	-2.2	-2.7	-2.2	-2.9	-2.5
Information and information processing [1 2]	86.9	86.7	86.2	86.3	-2.2	-1.8	-4.5	-2.7	-2.0	-3.6
Telephone services [1 2]	96.1	95.8	95.2	95.5	-.8	-2.0	-3.3	-2.5	-1.4	-2.9
Information technology, hardware and services [1 5]	15.4	15.3	15.3	15.2	-7.2	-2.5	-7.4	-5.1	-4.9	-6.3
Personal computers and peripheral equipment [1 2]	15.2	15.0	14.9	14.8	-2.5	-9.7	-7.5	-10.1	-6.2	-8.8
Other goods and services	311.6	312.9	313.5	314.4	1.2	2.5	1.3	3.6	1.8	2.5
Tobacco and smoking products [1]	476.9	481.6	482.6	483.9	1.4	2.3	2.3	6.0	1.8	4.1
Personal care	179.9	180.1	180.5	180.9	.9	2.7	.9	2.2	1.8	1.6
Personal care products [1]	154.3	153.9	153.1	154.0	.0	2.6	-1.8	-.8	1.3	-1.3
Personal care services [1]	197.5	198.1	199.5	199.7	-2.4	2.9	2.5	4.5	.2	3.5
Miscellaneous personal services	293.5	294.4	295.4	296.5	3.3	4.2	3.9	4.2	3.7	4.0
Commodity and service group										
Commodities	156.4	155.7	155.5	155.9	-4.4	7.6	6.7	-1.3	1.4	2.6
Food and beverages	186.4	186.9	187.0	187.0	5.9	1.3	5.1	1.3	3.6	3.2
Commodities less food and beverages	139.4	138.2	137.8	138.3	-10.7	11.9	7.8	-3.1	.0	2.2
Nondurables less food and beverages	162.0	161.3	160.3	158.4	.0	15.2	8.9	-8.6	7.3	-.3
Apparel	120.7	119.9	119.4	119.7	-1.7	3.0	.7	-3.3	.7	-1.3
Nondurables less food, beverages, and apparel	194.6	190.8	189.6	189.8	-15.8	32.1	20.3	-9.5	5.5	4.4
Durables	113.5	113.2	113.3	114.1	-6.4	.4	-1.7	2.1	-3.1	.2
Services	218.6	219.2	219.6	219.9	1.7	3.4	3.7	2.4	2.5	3.1
Rent of shelter [4]	204.4	204.9	205.1	205.7	2.2	3.2	3.2	2.6	2.7	2.9
Tenants' and household insurance [1 2]	116.5	116.3	116.5	116.8	-4.7	2.8	4.6	1.0	-1.0	2.8
Gas (piped) and electricity [3]	151.4	151.6	152.5	151.0	-5.9	4.8	16.0	-1.1	-.7	7.1
Water and sewer and trash collection services [2]	124.0	124.7	125.2	125.7	5.2	7.9	6.0	5.6	6.5	5.8
Household operations [1 2]	127.0	127.5	128.0	127.6	1.3	5.3	5.2	1.9	3.3	3.5
Transportation services	220.5	221.4	221.4	221.4	1.3	2.4	1.6	1.6	1.8	1.6
Medical care services	321.2	322.4	323.2	324.6	5.4	7.1	4.2	4.3	6.3	4.3
Other services	253.9	254.1	254.3	255.5	1.4	2.7	1.9	2.5	2.1	2.2
Special indexes										
All items less food	184.7	184.5	184.5	185.0	-2.6	6.1	5.1	.7	1.7	2.9
All items less shelter	177.2	176.8	176.8	177.1	-2.5	6.2	6.1	-.2	1.7	2.9
All items less medical care	179.7	179.6	179.6	179.9	-1.4	5.4	5.1	.4	1.9	2.7
Commodities less food	141.3	140.1	139.7	140.3	-10.0	11.4	7.7	-2.8	.1	2.3
Nondurables less food	163.7	163.3	162.3	160.5	.0	14.7	7.7	-7.6	7.1	-.2
Nondurables less food and apparel	193.9	190.2	189.0	189.1	-14.2	29.5	19.6	-9.5	5.4	4.0
Nondurables	174.9	174.5	174.2	173.1	3.1	7.6	7.4	-4.1	5.3	1.5
Services less rent of shelter [4]	207.4	207.9	208.3	208.7	2.2	2.2	4.6	2.5	2.2	3.5
Services less medical care services	210.7	211.2	211.6	211.9	2.0	2.7	3.7	2.3	2.3	3.0
Energy	156.7	153.5	152.8	152.4	-23.2	41.1	34.9	-10.5	4.1	9.9
All items less energy	189.4	189.7	189.8	190.3	1.3	2.4	2.6	1.9	1.8	2.2
All items less food and energy	190.5	190.7	190.9	191.4	.2	2.8	1.9	1.9	1.5	1.9
Commodities less food and energy commodities	139.3	139.0	139.0	139.5	-3.9	1.4	.0	.6	-1.3	.3
Energy commodities	170.3	164.1	162.0	162.5	-35.7	82.4	51.9	-17.1	8.3	12.2
Services less energy services	226.0	226.7	227.0	227.6	2.2	3.5	2.7	2.9	2.8	2.8

[1] Not seasonally adjusted.
[2] Indexes on a December 1997=100 base.
[3] This index series was calculated using a Laspeyres estimator. All other item stratum index series were calculated using a geometric means estimator.
[4] Indexes on a December 1984=100 base
[5] Indexes on a December 1988=100 base.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 6. Consumer Price Index for Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers (CPI-W): Selected areas, all items index

(1982-84=100, unless otherwise noted)

All items

CPI-W	Pricing schedule [1]	Indexes				Percent change to Sep.2004 from—			Percent change to Aug.2004 from—		
		June 2004	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	July 2004	Aug. 2004	Aug. 2003	June 2004	July 2004
U.S. city average	M	185.3	184.9	185.0	185.4	2.4	0.3	0.2	2.6	-0.2	0.1
Region and area size [2]											
Northeast urban	M	197.5	197.3	197.2	197.7	3.0	.2	.3	3.4	-.2	-.1
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	198.3	198.0	198.1	198.4	2.8	.2	.2	3.3	-.1	.1
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	118.8	119.1	118.7	119.2	3.6	.1	.4	3.7	-.1	-.3
Midwest urban	M	178.2	178.0	178.2	178.6	2.3	.3	.2	2.4	.0	.1
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	179.4	179.5	179.8	180.2	2.2	.4	.2	2.5	.2	.2
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	116.0	115.5	115.7	115.9	2.4	.3	.2	2.4	-.3	.2
Size D - Nonmetropolitan (less than 50,000)	M	174.1	173.7	173.4	173.7	2.2	.0	.2	2.1	-.4	-.2
South urban	M	179.7	179.3	179.4	179.7	2.5	.2	.2	2.6	-.2	.1
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	181.9	181.2	181.2	181.4	2.2	.1	.1	2.4	-.4	.0
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	115.3	115.2	115.3	115.4	2.7	.2	.1	2.9	.0	.1
Size D - Nonmetropolitan (less than 50,000)	M	180.0	179.4	179.5	180.7	2.7	.7	.7	2.3	-.3	.1
West urban	M	188.6	188.0	188.0	188.8	2.1	.4	.4	2.1	-.3	.0
Size A - More than 1,500,000	M	189.7	188.9	188.9	189.9	2.0	.5	.5	1.9	-.4	.0
Size B/C - 50,000 to 1,500,000 [3]	M	117.6	117.4	117.6	117.8	2.2	.3	.2	2.4	.0	.2
Size classes											
A [4]	M	171.7	171.3	171.4	171.8	2.3	.3	.2	2.5	-.2	.1
B/C [3]	M	116.4	116.2	116.2	116.5	2.6	.3	.3	2.7	-.2	.0
D	M	179.7	179.0	178.8	179.7	2.3	.4	.5	2.0	-.5	-.1
Selected local areas [5]											
Chicago-Gary-Kenosha, IL-IN-WI	M	182.5	182.4	183.2	183.1	1.8	.4	-.1	2.7	.4	.4
Los Angeles-Riverside-Orange County, CA	M	187.4	186.8	186.5	187.8	3.2	.5	.7	3.3	-.5	-.2
New York-Northern N.J.-Long Island, NY-NJ-CT-PA	M	200.4	200.1	200.3	200.6	2.9	.2	.1	3.2	.0	.1
Boston-Brockton-Nashua, MA-NH-ME-CT	1	-	207.9	-	208.8	1.3	.4	-	-	-	-
Cleveland-Akron, OH	1	-	172.8	-	174.8	3.1	1.2	-	-	-	-
Dallas-Fort Worth, TX	1	-	179.4	-	180.0	1.9	.3	-	-	-	-
Washington-Baltimore, DC-MD-VA-WV [6]	1	-	119.7	-	120.4	3.0	.6	-	-	-	-
Atlanta, GA	2	184.0	-	182.5	-	-	-	-	1.7	-.8	-
Detroit-Ann Arbor-Flint, MI	2	180.4	-	181.5	-	-	-	-	2.3	.6	-
Houston-Galveston-Brazoria, TX	2	167.6	-	167.4	-	-	-	-	3.0	-.1	-
Miami-Fort Lauderdale, FL	2	183.4	-	182.9	-	-	-	-	2.6	-.3	-
Philadelphia-Wilmington-Atlantic City, PA-NJ-DE-MD	2	197.3	-	198.0	-	-	-	-	4.7	.4	-
San Francisco-Oakland-San Jose, CA	2	195.4	-	195.0	-	-	-	-	1.4	-.2	-
Seattle-Tacoma-Bremerton, WA	2	190.4	-	189.6	-	-	-	-	.7	-.4	-

[1] Foods, fuels, and several other items priced every month in all areas; most other goods and services priced as indicated:
M - Every month.
1 - January, March, May, July, September, and November.
2 - February, April, June, August, October, and December.

[2] Regions defined as the four Census regions. See technical notes.

[3] Indexes on a December 1996=100 base.

[4] Indexes on a December 1986=100 base.

[5] In addition, the following metropolitan areas are published semiannually and appear in Tables 34 and 39 of the January and July issues of the CPI Detailed Report: Anchorage, AK; Cincinnati-Hamilton, OH-KY-IN; Denver-Boulder-Greeley, CO; Honolulu, HI; Kansas City, MO-KS; Milwaukee-Racine, WI; Minneapolis-St. Paul, MN-WI; Phoenix-Mesa, AZ; Pittsburgh, PA; Portland-Salem, OR-WA; St. Louis, MO-IL; San Diego, CA; Tampa-St. Petersburg-Clearwater, FL.

[6] Indexes on a November 1996=100 base.

- Data not available.

NOTE: Local area indexes are byproducts of the national CPI program. Each local index has a smaller sample size than the national index and is, therefore, subject to substantially more sampling and other measurement error. As a result, local area indexes show greater volatility than the national index, although their long-term trends are similar. Therefore, the Bureau of Labor Statistics strongly urges users to consider adopting the national average CPI for use in their escalator clauses.

NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.

Table 7. Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (C-CPI-U): U.S. city average, by expenditure category and commodity and service group

(December 1999=100, unless otherwise noted)

C-CPI-U	Relative importance, 2001-2002	Unadjusted indexes		Unadjusted percent change to Sep. 2004 from—	
		Aug. 2004	Sep. 2004	Sep. 2003	Aug. 2004
Expenditure category					
All items	100.000	110.3	110.6	2.1	0.3
Food and beverages	15.076	111.6	111.6	3.0	.0
Food	14.086	111.6	111.6	3.1	.0
Food at home	8.062	110.6	110.2	2.9	-.4
Food away from home	6.023	113.0	113.3	3.3	.3
Alcoholic beverages	.990	111.5	112.1	3.0	.5
Housing	41.793	115.0	114.9	2.6	-.1
Shelter	32.380	116.5	116.4	2.9	-.1
Fuels and utilities	4.643	128.9	128.2	4.2	-.5
Household furnishings and operations	4.771	95.0	95.1	-.8	.1
Apparel	4.317	87.8	91.5	-.8	4.2
Transportation	17.315	107.6	107.6	1.5	.0
Private transportation	16.206	107.8	108.0	1.9	.2
Public transportation	1.109	104.0	101.4	-3.4	-2.5
Medical care	5.783	121.9	122.2	4.3	.2
Medical care commodities	1.466	115.0	115.4	2.1	.3
Medical care services	4.317	124.4	124.6	5.0	.2
Recreation	5.978	103.3	103.3	-.1	.0
Education and communication	6.004	99.2	100.1	.6	.9
Education	2.560	133.5	136.0	6.5	1.9
Communication	3.444	78.6	78.8	-3.5	.3
Other goods and services	3.734	114.3	114.5	2.1	.2
Commodity and service group					
Services	58.567	117.0	117.0	2.7	.0
Commodities	41.433	101.8	102.3	1.3	.5
Durables	12.521	86.0	86.3	-1.8	.3
Nondurables	28.912	109.3	109.9	2.7	.5
All items less food and energy	78.985	108.0	108.4	1.6	.4
Energy	6.929	136.4	135.5	6.4	-.7

Indexes for 2004 are initial estimates. Indexes for 2003 are interim adjustments.
NOTE: Index applies to a month as a whole, not to any specific date.